Welcome to History of Video Games

We are a digital archive dedicated to exploring the evolution of interactive entertainment.

From the pixelated pioneers of the 1970s to the cinematic masterpieces of today, this site dives into the stories, innovations, and cultural moments that shaped gaming across generations.

Whether you're a longtime player or a curious newcomer, discover how video games became one of the most influential art forms of our time.



Explore by Company

- Play Station
- NINTENDO
- XBOX
- SEGA
- PC Gaming
- Arcade Classics
- Handheld Consoles
- Retro Systems (Atari, commodore, etc)
- Modern Platforms (Steam, Epic Games, etc)

Featured Articles



Final fantasy VII



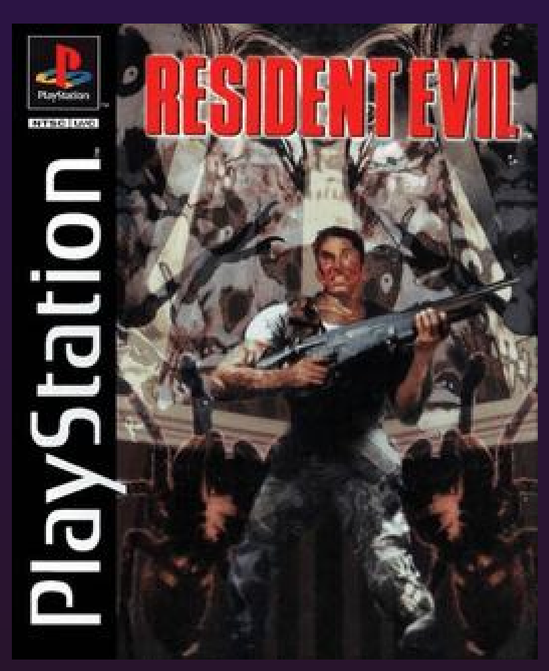
Halo Combat Evo



Crash Banicoot



Silent Hill



Resident Evil



Metal Gear Solid

PlayStation®

Articles about PlayStation Games



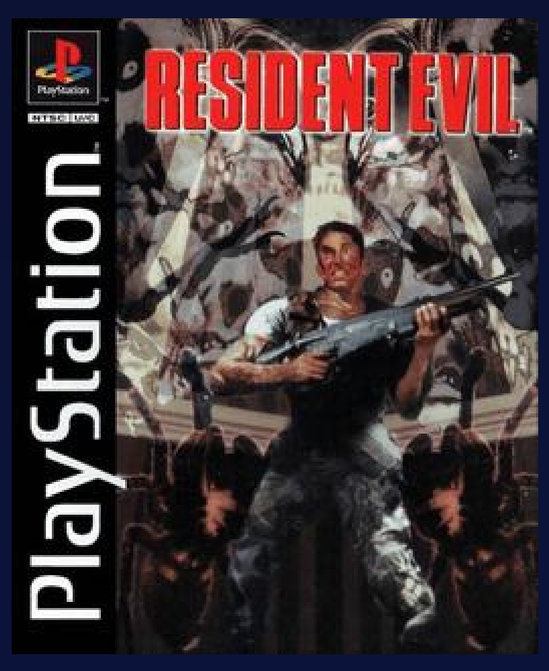
Metal Gear Solid



Final fantasy VII



Sypro Adventure



Resident Evil



Silent Hill



Crash Banicoot



CastleVania



Gran Turismo



Grand Theft Auto

History Of
Video Games

By Matthew Carrillo DMD 2470 Digital Publication Final



The Legacy of Final Fantasy VII (1997)

By Matthew Carrillo

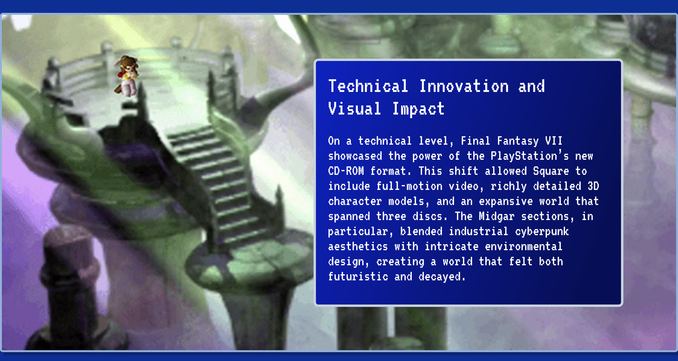
created November 2025

Few games have defined an era quite like Final Fantasy VII. Released in 1997 for the original Sony PlayStation, Square's ambitious role-playing game not only elevated its franchise but reshaped the global perception of what video games could achieve as a storytelling medium. Blending cinematic visuals, an orchestral-inspired soundtrack, and emotionally charged narrative design, Final Fantasy VII became a cultural landmark that still influences modern game development nearly three decades later.



A New Standard for RPG Storytelling

At the heart of Final Fantasy VII lies an unforgettable story. Players follow Cloud Strife, a former elite soldier turned mercenary, who joins the eco-terrorist group AVALANCHE in their struggle against the megacorporation Shinra. What begins as a mission to save the planet from industrial exploitation evolves into a much deeper exploration of identity, memory, and loss.
The game's storytelling was revolutionary for its time-delivered through cinematic cutscenes, in-game dialogue, and pre-rendered backgrounds that made each environment feel alive. It was one of the first titles to make players genuinely care about its characters, culminating in moments-such as Aerith's death-that remain among the most discussed in gaming history.



Technical Innovation and Visual Impact

On a technical level, Final Fantasy VII showcased the power of the PlayStation's new CD-ROM format. This shift allowed Square to include full-motion video, richly detailed 3D character models, and an expansive world that spanned three discs. The Midgar sections, in particular, blended industrial cyberpunk aesthetics with intricate environmental design, creating a world that felt both futuristic and decayed.



Composer Nobuo Uematsu's score elevated the experience further. Tracks like "One-Winged Angel" and "Aerith's Theme" demonstrated how video game music could carry emotional and dramatic weight comparable to cinema.

Cultural Influence and Enduring Popularity

Beyond its technical milestones, Final Fantasy VII had a profound impact on gaming culture. It introduced millions of players outside Japan to the JRPG genre, helping popularize narrative-driven games in the West. Its success also paved the way for cinematic storytelling in titles like Metal Gear Solid, Kingdom Hearts, and Mass Effect.
The game's world has since expanded through sequels, spin-offs, films, and, most recently, a multi-part remake series that reimagines the original story with modern visuals and gameplay. Each new adaptation reflects how deeply the 1997 original continues to resonate with fans and creators alike.



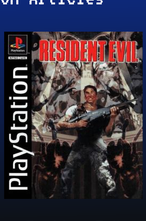
A Timeless Masterpiece

Even in today's era of ultra-realistic graphics and open-world design, Final Fantasy VII remains a benchmark for narrative ambition and emotional depth. Its characters, soundtrack, and themes of environmentalism and self-discovery continue to inspire players across generations.
More than a classic, Final Fantasy VII represents the moment video games proved they could tell stories as profound and moving as any other art form.

Related PlayStation Articles



Metal Gear Solid



Resident Evil